

sugar, ice and lemons you would use per cup. I'm sure I can come up with a very profitable business model!

Enough of time pass. I should be doing something productive now. I have a meeting lined up, and I start gathering all the reports for it. But my secretary has just told me that there's a slight delay—too short for me to start with work, so I log on to www.emode.com to find out a bit about myself. There is a huge collection of tests that can reveal a lot about my IQ (I think I'll skip those), my personality, lifestyle, the right career path, even my relationships! There's one that catches my eye—it's a test to find out which car matches my personality. The test scores show that I'm a practical person and the perfect car for me would be a Toyota, Honda or a Ford Escort. Now if only they would provide the required funds as well! I want to try out the other tests too, like the one which determines whether I'm in the right job and the matchmaker, but I'll hold them for later. PsychTests (www.psychtests.com) also has a truckload of personality tests.

4.30 pm. Whoa! That meeting looked like it would never end...

My head is spinning with all the ideas that were thrown up in the meeting and the things I need to do. At this moment I would give anything to be able to do something that doesn't require much thought!

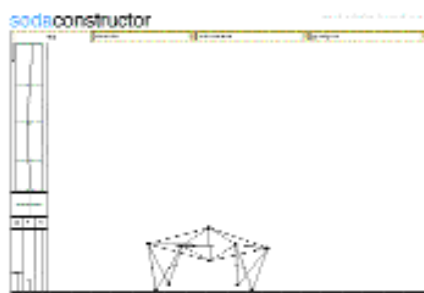
Snap Bubbles (www.snapbubbles.com) seems like the perfect place to do practically nothing—all you do is keep snapping the bubbles on virtual bubble wraps! The Reflex Tester Game at www.reflexgame.com is quite addictive. The deal is that when I click Start, the background colour changes after some time and I have to click Stop the moment it does. I have at times spent close to half an hour just hitting Start and Stop. I blame the caustic remarks that follow for egging me on! If I take more than a second to respond, the damn thing asks me if I fell asleep, and even at 0.28 seconds, it asks me to get better!

I think I'll go play some more intelligent games at www.sandlotscience.com instead. The slider puzzles are very engrossing—one tile is missing from a square and you have to slide them around till they form the correct picture. Fortunately, the ones here are quite simple.

A little nagging voice in my head is telling me to get back to work. I must heed it, else I'll land in trouble!

7.00 pm. I am waiting for my colleague to finish work so we can go home together...

I need to kill some time while my friend wraps up work for the day. Maybe I should try my hand at building robots! Sodaconstructor (www.sodaplay.com) gives me a neat little lab where I can do just that. It's all pretty simple and I can spend hours watching my creations crawl and float around under different conditions of gravity, friction, etc.



Sodaconstructor: Lazy bum to Einstein in minutes

Quiet Reading

11.30 pm. I'm waiting for sleep to take over...

It's been a typical hectic day at work and there's nothing interesting on TV. I really do need something that will help me relax. I think I'll just dig up some easy reading. OxymoronList.com (www.oxymoronlist.com) seems like a nice spot to visit. It claims to have the largest collection of oxymorons online. Ever thought of how someone can be 'awfully nice'? Or why they call it the 'Peace Force'? Maybe I can use a few for my next report. Here's another feel-good destination that never fails to cheer me up—www.goodquotes.com. My favourite sections are Famous Last Words and Bumper Stickers. The Answering Machine messages are quite entertaining too, but the pickup lines are quite silly.

Bloopers have been my all-time favourite. Bloopers are mistakes that find their way to the public. Usually they get recorded in movies and TV shows, but can be found in print too. Slip Ups (www.slipups.com) has a huge collection of bloopers and www.eeggs.com has a whole list of Easter eggs—amusing items hidden in software, movies, music, etc. There are thousands of them and they can be quite entertaining. I've seen *ET* several times, but I completely missed this blooper—the refrigerator in the film repeatedly changes colour! Nor did I notice that in *Gone with the Wind*, when Kip Rennes is in the



Signs You are Wasting Too Much Time

- What you read on the Net becomes the subject of most of your social conversations.
- You spend most of your free time building up strategies for solving games and puzzles.
- You get bored by what's supposed to kill boredom.
- The language from these Web sites finds its way into your monthly reports.
- Forum members and Webmasters become your heroes.
- You start ignoring nature's calls to get more time at these sites.
- You start looking forward to the daily joke more than the e-mail from your girlfriend/boyfriend.
- The number of jokes you receive by e-mail crosses the amount of spam you receive daily.
- You've already bookmarked most of the sites in this article.
- Your Favorites are neatly organised into Puzzles, Jokes, Quotes... and you have just one folder called Work.

car being crushed by Raymond Kalitrey, the back window of the car smashes. A little later, it smashes again!

While I am surfing for more entertaining reading, I stumble across News of the Weird (www.newsoftheweird.com). It has a collection of bizarre but true news items from the United States. Reading one news item a day from here will surely keep boredom away. I read one about a 34-year-old woman from Texas who was attacked by three lions in a pen at a game park in South Africa when she started petting one of them.

Confessions from people at www.daily-confession.com are more fun—these are personal accounts of people's doings. There's this confession from a person who loathes jaywalkers and has a deep-seated urge to hit them! There's another from a poor guy who hates wearing glasses in public because one of his ears is slightly higher than the other! Even funnier are other people's responses to these confessions.

My journey through cyberspace in the quest for the interesting and the puerile takes me to www.elibs.com. This site has a very interesting concept: I type a few words and it spins an amusing story using them. If you don't want to sit about typing words, you can just read some of the stories